BERNSTEIN
SOCIETE GENERALE GROUP

Global Energy Storage

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Battery Weekly 12 October

America

'Toyota Battery Center in North America' opens in Michigan- electrive.com Toyota has opened the Toyota Battery Center of North America (TBC) in Saline, Michigan, a 30,000 sq. ft. (c.2,800 sqm) facility dedicated to battery development, testing and evaluation across the full lifecycle, from raw materials through recycling. The center will support batteries for hybrid, plug-in hybrid, hydrogen and fully electric vehicles, as well as Toyota's battery manufacturing operations in North Carolina and vehicle plants across North America. Toyota will also collaborate with the University of Michigan Electric Vehicle Center, extending access to the facility for battery research and workforce development.

PNT to Showcase Integrated Battery Production Solutions in US, India.- thelec.net PNT will showcase its integrated battery manufacturing capabilities at The Battery Show North America on October 13–15 and The Battery Show India on October 22–24. Together with its subsidiaries, the company will present electrode, separator and copper foil production equipment, alongside cathode materials and LFP batteries for ESS. PNT already produces cathode materials and LFP batteries at its Gumi Plant 4, leveraging this experience to expand beyond equipment supply into production-line development, mass-production support and materials supply.

LG Energy Solution Secures 240,000 Tons of Lithium Concentrate Over Four Years.- thelec.net LG Energy Solution has signed a binding agreement with Elevra Lithium to source 240,000 tonnes of spodumene concentrate from the operating North American Lithium mine in Quebec, with deliveries starting in late 2026. LGES describes the supply as spanning four years, strengthening its regional battery supply chain and providing flexibility to process the concentrate into either lithium carbonate or lithium hydroxide for EV and ESS applications. Elevra describes the contract as a three-year term from the first shipment, with scheduled deliveries covering 2026–2029.

VW ID.4 Recalled Over Fire Risk, Owners Told Not To Charge Past 80%.- insideevs Volkswagen is recalling 22,524 model-year 2023–2026 ID.4 vehicles in the US over a potential fire risk involving batteries supplied by SK Battery America. Certain charging profiles combined with a state of charge above 80% may trigger thermal propagation, although the root cause remains unknown. VW estimates 0.1% of recalled vehicles have the defect and is advising affected owners to limit charging to 80% while a permanent remedy is developed.

Asia

LG Energy Solution to Compensate Battery Equipment Maker 10 Billion Won.- thelec.net LG Energy Solution has reportedly agreed to pay Jayce Robotics around KRW 10 billion in additional compensation after specification upgrades increased costs under its original KRW 53.8 billion equipment contract for four production lines at the Lansing, Michigan plant. The equipment supports LGES's first mass-production line for prismatic LFP batteries for Tesla Megapack, with installation and trial operations scheduled for 2027. Despite negotiations lasting more than six months, the project is not expected to face major construction delays

POSCO Future M Signs 6 Trillion-Won LFP Deal With Samsung SDI.- thelec.net POSCO Future M has signed a KRW 6 trillion LFP cathode material supply agreement with Samsung SDI, more than doubling the 190,000 tonnes previously agreed for 2027–2032. The revised partnership shifts part of the existing NCA supply to LFP and adds further volumes, increasing total battery-material supply by around 45%. The companies also plan to expand cooperation into LMO cathode materials and artificial graphite anodes, strengthening Samsung SDI's materials supply chain in response to US prohibited foreign entity restrictions.

See the Disclosure Appendix of this report for required disclosures, analyst certifications and other important information. Alternatively, visit our Global Research Disclosure Website.

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India to Invest 500 Billion Rupees in BESS by 2033.- thelec.net India has approved Green Energy Corridor Phase III, allocating INR 500 billion to deploy 50 GWh of battery storage by FY2032–33 within a broader INR 1.86 trillion program supporting transmission infrastructure for 135 GW of renewable energy. The storage will address intermittency, grid congestion and peak-hour curtailment while supplying electricity during non-solar hours. With domestic cell capacity currently around 2 GWh annually, the expansion is expected to sustain import demand and create opportunities for Korean battery and equipment suppliers as local manufacturers scale up.

EcoPro BM, Samsung SDI to Jointly Develop Solid-State Battery Materials.- thelec.net EcoPro BM and Samsung SDI have signed an MOU to jointly develop sulfide-based solid-state batteries, targeting commercialization in 2027. Samsung SDI will lead cell development and mass-production technology, while EcoPro BM will develop cathode materials and solid electrolytes for cathodes and separators. The collaboration spans early-stage R&D, quality evaluation and production readiness, building on EcoPro BM's existing 40-tonne annual solid-electrolyte pilot capacity.

BYD to Supply Poland's Largest 600 MW/2.4 GWh Battery Storage Project.- solarbe.com Greenvolt Power has started construction of the 600 MW/2.4 GWh Siedlce BESS project in Poland, with commercial operation targeted for end-2027. BYD Energy Storage will supply its BYD Haohan battery system for the project, which is set to become Poland's largest battery storage facility and has secured revenues through the country's capacity market. Together with two earlier 200 MW/800 MWh projects, the partnership will deliver 1 GW/4 GWh of storage in Poland, supporting grid flexibility and renewable energy integration.

Chery's Deyi Energy Tops Out RMB 4 Billion, 20 GWh Battery Plant in Anhui.- solarbe.com Anhui Deyi Energy Technology, Chery's battery manufacturing subsidiary, has completed structural construction of its 20 GWh battery plant in Suzhou, Anhui, backed by RMB 4 billion in fixed-asset investment. The facility targets full capacity by end-2027, producing 187 Ah and 166 Ah blade-format batteries alongside 684 Ah energy storage cells. The project covers 220,500 m², including cell and PACK workshops, expanding Chery's in-house manufacturing capabilities across EV and stationary storage applications.

CBAK Energy Signs Agreement for 12 GWh Sodium-Ion Battery Project in Nanjing.- solarbe.com CBAK Energy has signed an investment agreement for a 12 GWh large cylindrical battery project in Nanjing, featuring flexible production lines capable of manufacturing sodium-ion or lithium-ion cells according to market demand. Development is planned for 2H27, subject to financing, customer demand and project readiness. Separately, the company targets a 6 GWh expansion by end-2026, raising its existing Nanjing facility's annual capacity from 4.5 GWh to 10.5 GWh. Sodium-ion samples remain under customer testing for residential and portable storage and electric mobility applications, rather than commercial-scale production.

Europe

Fraunhofer opens research centre in Braunschweig- electrive.com Fraunhofer has opened its Center for Energy Storage and Systems (ZESS) in Braunschweig, Germany, backed by €49.85 million from the federal government and Lower Saxony. The 3,300 m² facility, including 1,750 m² of laboratories and a 450 m² dry room, focuses on next-generation solid-state batteries, production technologies and hydrogen systems. Combining expertise from three Fraunhofer institutes, the centre aims to accelerate industrial scaling and commercialization while covering the full battery process chain, from materials development to sustainability and recycling.

Fraunhofer expands South Korean battery research partnership- electrive.com Fraunhofer Battery Alliance has signed two MOUs with POSTECH, the city of Pohang and Korea Environment Corporation (K-eco) to deepen cooperation across battery materials, cell manufacturing and recycling. Joint research will use Fraunhofer FFB's PreFab facility in Münster to test new materials and production processes under near-industrial conditions, supporting their transition to large-scale manufacturing. The K-eco partnership will focus on recycled-material certification and quality assurance, including approaches supporting compliance with the EU Battery Regulation.

Researchers explore potential of lithium-sulphur batteries- electrive.com Researchers at Vanderbilt University and the University of Maryland have developed a chlorine-assisted lithium-sulfur battery chemistry that increases sulfur's charge-storage capacity by 58% and raises average operating voltage from 2.05 V to 2.54 V. The approach could enable 477 Wh/kg at the stack level, around 37% above the conventional lithium-sulfur system tested for comparison. A prototype pouch cell retained 78% capacity after 100 cycles, although further improvements in durability, sulfur loading and electrolyte usage are needed before commercialization.

CATL opens largest Ning Service Centre outside Asia in Oslo.- electrive.com CATL has opened an 8,000 m² Ning Service Centre in Oslo, its largest outside Asia, to serve Norway and the wider Nordic region with battery diagnostics, maintenance, repair, second-life applications and recycling. The facility will also become its main Nordic technician-training hub, supporting a shift from full battery replacement toward targeted repairs; CATL says complex repair turnaround has fallen from 72 to 48 hours. Ning Service currently operates 1,394 locations across 85 countries and regions, targeting 10,000 locations by 2030 as it expands its global battery aftermarket network.

SK On's Hungary Plant Wins Ford's Top Quality Certification.- thelec.net SK On's Iváncsa plant in Hungary has received Ford's Q1 supplier quality certification, just over two years after starting mass production in 2Q24. The certification covers manufacturing processes, product quality, continuous improvement and quality-management systems, following an assessment from late 2025 through 1H26. The plant has 30 GWh of annual battery capacity, bringing SK On's total Hungarian capacity to 47.5 GWh alongside its two Komárom facilities.

Schneider Electric, Samsung SDI Partner on Renewable Energy Procurement in Europe.- thelec.net Samsung SDI has signed a 15-year, 84.19 MW virtual power purchase agreement (VPPA) with Spanish renewable energy developer BRUC, supported by Schneider Electric. The agreement covers approximately 200,000 MWh annually from a Spanish solar project starting in January 2027, supporting renewable electricity procurement for Samsung SDI's Hungarian battery plant and its RE100 commitment. The long-term arrangement is also expected to reduce exposure to renewable energy certificate price fluctuations and procurement risks.

Others

POSCO Holdings Completes Second Lithium Plant in Argentina.- thelec.net POSCO Holdings has completed the upstream facility of its second lithium plant in Argentina, adding 23,000 tonnes of annual lithium carbonate capacity following a US$954 million investment, bringing total local capacity to 48,000 tonnes annually. The output will be processed into battery-grade lithium hydroxide at its Yulchon facility in South Korea, scheduled for completion in 2027, supporting a combined 50,000-tonne annual lithium hydroxide production system. POSCO also plans third and fourth Argentine plants, targeting 100,000 tonnes of annual brine-based lithium capacity by 2033, including supply for LFP energy storage batteries.

Four-hour battery storage now beats gas peaking on cost globally.- woodmac.com Wood Mackenzie finds that four-hour battery storage has a lower levelized cost than open-cycle gas turbines in all 43 markets modeled, as battery manufacturing scale reduces storage costs while turbine shortages and fuel volatility raise gas peaking costs. China's storage costs are more than 55% below the rest of Asia Pacific's average, highlighting its supply-chain advantage. In the Middle East and Africa, four-hour storage costs are forecast to decline 33% to US$80/MWh by 2035, strengthening the economics of batteries for renewable energy integration and peak-demand supply.

EXHIBIT 1: **Key commodities price performance**

	Price 9-Oct	Ccy	Mkt cap $bn	P/E 26E	EV /EBITDA 26E	%1D	%1W	%1M	%1Y	1Y px chart
Metal prices (US$/tonne)										
LiCO (spot)	19,167					-2.2%	-2%	-14%	87%	
LiOH (spot)	17,675					-2.3%	-2%	-15%	70%	
LiCO (contract)	18,750					0.0%	0%	4%	97%	
LiOH (contract)	18,500					0.0%	0%	0%	104%	
Cobalt (spot)	38,814					0.0%	0%	-10%	-6%	
Nickel (spot)	15,553					-1.2%	0%	-8%	0%	
Component prices										
Cathode NMC811						0.0%	-1%	-8%	16%	
Cathode LFP						0.0%	1%	-10%	40%	
Precursor NMC811						0.0%	-1%	-4%	-4%	
Precursor LFP						0.0%	0%	1%	53%	
Artificial Graphite						0.0%	0%	0%	6%	
Natural Graphite						0.0%	0%	0%	0%	
Electrolyte NMC						0.0%	0%	2%	35%	
Electrolyte LFP						0.0%	0%	2%	53%	
Separator						0.0%	0%	0%	28%	
Spot battery cell cost (US$/kWh)										
LFP	59					0.0%	0%	-2%	12%	
NMC532	78					0.0%	0%	-5%	10%	
NMC622	75					0.0%	0%	-5%	6%	
NMC811	78					0.0%	0%	-4%	10%	
Spot battery pack cost (US$/kWh)										
LFP	71					0.0%	0%	-2%	-6%	
NMC532	110					0.0%	0%	-4%	7%	
NMC622	108					0.0%	0%	-4%	4%	
NMC811	111					0.0%	0%	-3%	7%	

Source: Bloomberg, Baiinfo, Bernstein analysis and estimates (cell and pack cost)

EXHIBIT 2: **Key companies price performance and valuation**

	Price 9-Oct	Ccy	Mkt cap $bn	P/E 26E	EV /EBITDA 26E	%1D	%1W	%1M	%1Y	1Y px chart
Cell makers										
LGES	401,000	KRW	69.9	n.a.	16.5x	2.6%	8%	14%	1%	
Samsung SDI	569,000	KRW	34.2	81.3x	17.1x	1.2%	8%	7%	176%	
CATL	291.0	CNY	205.0	14.0x	9.8x	1.5%	0%	-13%	-29%	
CALB	15.6	HKD	3.5	8.9x	2.1x	-1.5%	-3%	-9%	-56%	
EVE Energy	50.5	CNY	16.4	15.0x	9.5x	0.1%	1%	0%	-44%	
Gotion	30.4	CNY	8.2	27.8x	6.7x	-2.8%	3%	18%	-38%	
Sunwoda	20.9	CNY	5.8	19.2x	6.2x	-3.0%	-5%	22%	-39%	
Farasis	9.7	CNY	1.8	n.a.	n.a.	2.3%	5%	7%	-53%	
Lithium Miners/Refiners										
Albemarle	102.1	USD	12.0	9.0x	4.4x	-0.6%	-2%	-21%	6%	
SQM	64.5	USD	17.9	9.1x	4.3x	-0.1%	0%	-15%	49%	
Pilbara Minerals	3.5	AUD	7.9	19.4x	9.6x	-4.7%	-5%	-28%	32%	
Ganfeng Lithium	29.3	HKD	12.4	6.9x	6.8x	-0.2%	-2%	-20%	-43%	
Tianqi Lithium	40.1	CNY	9.7	9.8x	3.5x	-1.5%	0%	-12%	-22%	
Cathode										
LG Chem	286,500	KRW	15.1	n.a.	2.7x	3.4%	9%	5%	3%	
EcoPro BM	128,800	KRW	9.6	652.7x	63.7x	3.5%	11%	21%	14%	
L&F	116,200	KRW	3.5	n.a.	16.0x	-1.2%	2%	1%	57%	
Umicore	20.6	EUR	5.7	11.1x	4.9x	-0.9%	-3%	-11%	21%	
Ningbo Ronbay	24.3	CNY	2.6	43.4x	11.7x	-0.2%	4%	0%	-24%	
Beijing Easpring	41.3	CNY	3.4	20.1x	12.9x	0.1%	6%	9%	-42%	
GEM	6.2	CNY	4.8	16.7x	5.2x	0.6%	2%	-3%	-30%	
Huayou Cobalt	34.7	CNY	9.8	8.9x	3.8x	-1.6%	-1%	-9%	-51%	
Dynanonic	43.4	CNY	1.8	14.5x	5.8x	2.1%	9%	4%	-4%	
Anode										
Posco	193,100	KRW	12.8	562.6x	52.0x	0.9%	3%	6%	32%	
Putailai	22.2	CNY	7.1	14.6x	9.1x	1.5%	3%	0%	-28%	
Shanshan	11.8	CNY	4.0	n.a.	n.a.	-0.3%	3%	2%	-24%	
Separator										
Asahi Kasei	1,597	JPY	13.8	14.7x	5.4x	-3.2%	-2%	2%	31%	
SK IE	18,600	KRW	1.1	n.a.	-23.1x	1.8%	5%	14%	-31%	
Toray Industries	1,233	JPY	11.7	22.9x	7.1x	0.4%	1%	2%	27%	
W-Scope	147	JPY	0.1	n.a.	n.a.	-1.3%	4%	-9%	-35%	
Yunnan Energy	46.7	CNY	6.8	20.7x	7.9x	1.8%	3%	-3%	-5%	
Shenzhen Senior	15.5	CNY	3.2	31.4x	10.0x	-0.9%	-2%	12%	4%	
Sinoma Science	50.6	CNY	12.7	28.0x	11.8x	-2.7%	-7%	1%	49%	
Electrolyte										
Enchem	22,000	KRW	0.4	n.a.	n.a.	-5.2%	-3%	3%	-68%	
Tinci Minerals	34.3	CNY	10.4	11.1x	7.9x	5.0%	10%	2%	-12%	
Capchem	63.2	CNY	7.1	21.5x	15.8x	-5.5%	-5%	-6%	21%	
Jiangsu Guotai	7.7	CNY	1.9	9.7x	n.a.	0.5%	1%	-1%	-17%	
Shanshan	11.8	CNY	4.0	n.a.	n.a.	-0.3%	3%	2%	-24%	
Equipment Maker										
Hirano	1,755	JPY	0.2	16.6x	n.a.	0.7%	-1%	-6%	8%	
CKD	5,740	JPY	2.5	30.8x	16.1x	2.0%	0%	14%	73%	
Wuxi Lead	36.9	CNY	9.0	25.1x	20.0x	-1.9%	5%	19%	-41%	
Shenzhen Yinghe	22.1	CNY	2.1	21.5x	12.9x	1.1%	4%	5%	-36%	
Zhejiang HangKe	20.1	CNY	1.8	22.8x	18.7x	-1.2%	-1%	-2%	-43%	
Guangdong Lyric	44.8	CNY	1.1	48.4x	19.7x	-0.5%	6%	39%	-37%	
Shenzhen United	18.9	CNY	1.0	19.2x	11.8x	-2.7%	-6%	-9%	-28%	

Source: Bloomberg (all estimates), Bernstein analysis

Company Models

CATL | LG Energy Solution | Samsung SDI

LG Chem | EcoPro BM | Posco Future M

Tianqi Lithium

Sungrow

Industry Models

Model: ESS tracker

Model: Monthly EV Tracker

Model: Battery Gigafactory Database

Industry model: Global EV TAM

Industry model: Global ESS TAM

Industry model: Battery TAM

Industry model: Battery supply and demand

Blackbook

Battery Utopia

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CATL: HK IPO - key investor questions answered

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Global Energy Storage: More downside risks ahead for Korean cathode makers

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CATL: Initial perspectives on HK IPO Plans

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Global Energy Storage: Outlook 2025. New markets to drive battery growth

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

			8 Oct 2026		TTM	Reported EPS				Reported P/E (x)	
Ticker	Rating	Cur	Closing Price	Price Target	Rel. Perf.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
300750.CH (CATL)	O	CNY	286.75	770.00	(49.6)%	CNY	16.14	21.10	26.28	17.8	13.6	10.9
3750.HK (CATL)	O	HKD	476.80	740.00	(38.1)%	CNY	16.14	21.10	26.28	25.2	19.3	15.5
051910.KS (LG Chem)	M	KRW	286,500	312,000	(17.1)%	KRW	(13,258.70)	2,693.22	28,743	(21.6)	106.4	10.0
373220.KS (LGES)	M	KRW	401,000	351,000	(19.8)%	KRW	(4,580.94)	(2,364.33)	10,225	(87.5)	(169.6)	39.2
006400.KS (SDI)	M	KRW	569,000	520,000	155.2%	KRW	(9,933.80)	1,751.66	18,577	(57.3)	324.8	30.6
247540.KS (EcoPro BM)	U	KRW	128,800	140,000	(6.5)%	KRW	403.00	854.00	1,963.00	319.6	150.8	65.6
300274.CH (Sungrow)	O	RMB	80.49	151.00	(69.6)%	RMB	6.55	6.93	7.95	12.3	11.6	10.1
002466.CH (Tianqi Lithium)	O	CNY	40.69	80.00	(41.0)%	CNY	0.28	3.90	7.75	144.2	10.4	5.3
9696.HK (Tianqi Lithium)	O	HKD	27.22	65.00	(64.3)%	CNY	0.28	3.90	7.75	82.3	5.9	3.0
ASIAX			1,932.23									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

DISCLOSURE APPENDIX

I. REQUIRED DISCLOSURES

References to "Bernstein" or the “Firm” in these disclosures relate to the following entities: Bernstein Institutional Services LLC (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein & Co., LLC (pre April 1, 2024), Bernstein Autonomous LLP, BSG France S.A. (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein (Hong Kong) Limited 盛博香港有限公司, Sanford C. Bernstein (Canada) Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein (India) Private Limited (SEBI registration no. INH000006378), Sanford C. Bernstein (Singapore) Private Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein Japan KK（サンフォード・C・バーンスタイン株式会社）and analysts employed by Société Générale Africa Technologies & Services to produce Bernstein research under a Global Services Agreement in place between Bernstein and Société Générale.

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EQUITY RATINGS DEFINITIONS

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